

# Business Canvas Project — Assignment 1.4-1.5

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## CED Tasks 3–6: Validate the Problem → Design the Solution → Test the Fit → Define the Organization

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**Due:** \_\_\_\_ **Team size:** Same individual / team as Assignment 1A (up to 3) **Submission:** Completed Business Canvas **Customer (validated problem) + Product (idea + hypothesis evidence) + Organization (values, competencies, vision, mission, type)** sections + this worksheet

This is the **third checkpoint** of your Business Canvas Project. In Assignment 1A you looked **inside** your market at the competitors; in Assignment 1.3 you looked **outside** it at the six PESTEL forces. Now you go back to where every business starts: **the idea itself**. Where did yours come from — a gap, an opportunity, or an existing business you are adapting? Is the problem **real** — can you prove that multiple customers actually have it? What will you build to solve it, and how do you know the solution **fits** before spending real money? And once the product exists: what does your business **believe**, what is it **good at**, and where is it **going**?

In Assignment 1A you *identified* a problem. Identification is not validation. The CED is explicit: validation means gathering evidence that the problem **exists**, can be **clearly defined**, and is **experienced by multiple potential customers** (EK 1.4.C.1). In this assignment you gather that evidence in real interviews, design a product around it, test the fit with a hypothesis — and then write the vision and mission statements that will steer every later decision.

**Review first:** [[1.4 How Business Ideas Originate - Vocab]] · [[1.4 How Business Ideas Originate - Slides]] · [[1.5 Vision - Vocab]] · [[1.5 Vision - Slides]]

### CED Tasks covered:

- **Task 3:** "Conduct customer interviews to validate the problem, need, or want." (LO 1.4.C · Skills 2.A, 4.B)
  - **Task 4:** "Develop a solution to address a potential customer's problem, need, or want." (LO 1.4.C · Skill 2.A)
  - **Task 5:** "Formulate and test a business hypothesis related to problem-solution fit." (LO 1.4.C · Skill 2.B)
  - **Task 6:** "Develop a vision statement and a mission statement." (LO 1.5.B · Skill 4.B)
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## Deliverables

| Canvas Section | What You Submit                                                                            | AP Topic | CED Task       |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------------|
| Customer       | Validated problem statement + interview evidence                                           | 1.4      | Task 3         |
| Product        | Product idea that achieves problem-solution fit + hypothesis test                          | 1.4      | Task 4, Task 5 |
| Organization   | Core values + core competencies + vision statement + mission statement + organization type | 1.5      | Task 6         |

Customer and Product are canvas elements marked \* in the CED — they **require hypothesis testing**. Your interview validation (Section 2) and fit test (Section 4) are that evidence.

## Where This Fits — Project Progress

| # | Checkpoint                                                                           | Topics          | Assignment             | Status          |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------------|-----------------|
| 1 | Customer problem + competitors + competitive advantage plan                          | 1.1, 1.2        | Assignment 1A          | ✓ Done          |
| 2 | PESTEL analysis + market verdict                                                     | 1.3             | Assignment 1.3         | ✓ Done          |
| 3 | <b>Validation interviews + product idea + hypothesis test + vision &amp; mission</b> | <b>1.4, 1.5</b> | <b>This assignment</b> | ● Current       |
| 4 | Production process + supply chain plan                                               | 1.8             | Assignment 1C          | After Topic 1.8 |
| 5 | Commit to the idea + revised market analysis + integrated canvas                     | 1.1–1.8         | Unit 1 Final Canvas    | End of Unit 1   |

**Suggested pacing (≈2 weeks, matching the CED's 6 periods for 1.4 + 3 for 1.5):**

| Milestone                      | By     | You bring to class                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>M1 — Question check</b>     | Day 2  | Section 1 complete + your 5–7 interview questions, <b>peer-reviewed</b> in class (open-ended? neutral? about the problem, not your solution?) |
| <b>M2 — Validation verdict</b> | Day 6  | 3+ interviews conducted; Section 2 complete                                                                                                   |
| <b>M3 — Fit verdict</b>        | Day 10 | MVP built, hypothesis test run, Sections 3–4 complete                                                                                         |
| <b>M4 — Submit</b>             | Day 12 | Section 5 complete; full worksheet submitted                                                                                                  |

**Do not conduct interviews before M1.** Question quality decides everything downstream — a leading question poisons the evidence. The interview is about **their** problem, not your solution.

## Before You Start: The Framework

The design-thinking loop from 1.4 (EK 1.4.C.1–1.4.C.3) — this assignment *is* stages 2–5:

| Stage              | What happens                                                                                                                                  | Where                   |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>1. Observe</b>  | You spotted a problem                                                                                                                         | ✅ Done in Assignment 1A |
| <b>2. Validate</b> | Interviews give evidence the problem exists, is clearly defined, and is experienced by multiple potential customers                           | Section 2               |
| <b>3. Ideate</b>   | Brainstorm, sketch, prototype a solution                                                                                                      | Section 3               |
| <b>4. Test</b>     | Gather feedback on an <b>MVP</b> — "the simplest version of the product idea, with only core features... a sketch, a description, or a model" | Section 4               |
| <b>5. Define</b>   | Values, competencies, vision, mission, organization type                                                                                      | Section 5               |

Three rules from the 1.4 lesson you will need:

1. **A complaint is not a gap.** "Someone needs it" ≠ "no one meets it." 共享雨伞 failed the fake-gap test — a ¥20 umbrella already met the need better than a ¥19 deposit plus rental. Before you interview, know how people solve this problem **today** and why that is unsatisfactory.
2. **Demand ≠ viability.** 共享自习室 was full every night and still barely broke even; 密室逃脱 had queues and still collapsed because nobody came twice. Crowds prove desirability, not a business — which is why your test (Section 4) must measure **behavior, not opinions**.
3. **Opinions don't count; behavior does.** "Would you buy this?" is an opinion. A pre-order, a real purchase, a sign-up, a second use — that is evidence. The CED's own example: don't survey whether students want healthier snacks — **offer the snacks and count who buys**.

#### And three from 1.5:

1. **Values are chosen; competencies are built; ethics are owed.** A value is what the business **believes**; a competency is what it is **good at**. The exam loves to swap this pair — keep the discipline in Section 5.
2. **Test a stated value by what it cost.** A value the business abandons the first time money appears was a **decoration** — Seesaw's "craft" died in the 9.9-yuan price war; Patagonia's transparency, "Don't Buy This Jacket," and free lifetime repairs all **cost real money and held**.
3. **Vision = a future worth wanting (no operations). Mission = what it does and how (the work).** Classify by **content**, not by the label on the document — Alibaba's official "mission" reads like a vision.

**Strong-answer method (use it all through this worksheet): State the evidence → name the concept (LO/EK) → tie it to YOUR business.**

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## SECTION 1: IDEA AUDIT — Where Did Your Idea Come From?

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*AP Topic 1.4 · LO 1.4.A · EK 1.4.A.1, 1.4.A.2*

Before validating the problem, classify your idea's **source** — the exam asks this about scenarios, and FRQ 1 may ask it about **your own** business.

| Source (from class)                                                                                                                    | Part of your idea's origin? | Your evidence — the specific fact, observation, or change |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Gap</b> — a specific need not currently being met (competitors may exist — "none sell sugar-free" is a gap inside a crowded market) | Y / N                       |                                                           |
| <b>Opportunity</b> — a change (technology, trend, rule, resource) that makes a new or better way possible                              | Y / N                       |                                                           |
| <b>Existing business / replication</b> — a model you are copying, adapting, or improving (塔斯汀 copied 华莱士 before it innovated)          | Y / N                       |                                                           |

Most real ideas combine more than one source — the exam rewards you for naming **all** of them.

## 1A. The fake-gap check (共享雨伞 test)

**How do my target customers solve this problem today?**

**Why is the current solution unsatisfactory** (too expensive, too slow, unavailable, wrong features)?

**Could a customer make, buy, or own something that meets the need about as well — for less trouble than my product?** (If yes, you may have a complaint, not a gap.)

## 1B. The "why now" test

**If your idea depends on a recent change** (new technology, new rule, new trend — like mobile payment enabling deposit-free rental), **name the change and roughly when it happened:**

**Is that change the source of your idea, or an enabler** — the reason the idea is possible *now*? (In class: mobile payment was the **enabler**; the source was the gap — "phone dying with nowhere to charge." Enablers answer "why now," not "where from.")

## 1C. Strengths match (the two offers)

Remember the snack box's two offers: the mega cart ran on **someone else's money**; the far-field table ran on **his** logistics and reputation. Pursue the opportunities your strengths can win

(EK 1.5.A.4 previews this).

**What strengths does your team actually bring?** (skills, time, resources, connections)

**Which parts of this business run on those strengths — and which run on things you would have to buy or borrow?**

Self-check:

- ☐ I named **at least one source** with specific evidence — EK 1.4.A.2
- ☐ I ran the **fake-gap check** — how the need is met today and why that is unsatisfactory
- ☐ I distinguished the **source** from the **enabler** ("why now")
- ☐ I checked whether the opportunity runs on **our strengths** or on someone else's resources

SECTION 2: TASK 3 — VALIDATION INTERVIEWS

AP Topic 1.4 · LO 1.4.C · EK 1.4.C.1, EK 1.4.A.2 · Skill 4.B

Interviewing, surveying, and observing potential customers are the CED's own strategies for identifying needs (EK 1.4.A.2). Now gather the evidence it demands.

**Validation = evidence that the problem (1) exists, (2) can be clearly defined, and (3) is experienced by multiple potential customers. — EK 1.4.C.1**

Step 1 — Write 5–7 interview questions

| Rule                                          | Broken version                                  | Fixed version                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Open-ended                                    | "Do you think snacks are too expensive?"        | "How do you usually handle snacks on game day?"                                   |
| Neutral — no leading wording                  | "Wouldn't you say there's nowhere good to eat?" | "Walk me through where you ate last Saturday."                                    |
| About the problem — never pitch your solution | "Would you use my pre-order app?"               | "What do you do when you're hungry at the field?"                                 |
| Professional etiquette                        | —                                               | Ask consent; keep to 10–15 minutes; take notes; send a short thank-you afterwards |

## Step 2 — Interview at least 3 people who match your 1A target customer

At least one must be **outside your immediate friend group** (friends tell you what you want to hear; strangers tell you the truth).

## Step 3 — Log the findings

| # | Interviewee (initials) | Matches target customer? | Key findings — numbers and quotes | Problem exists for this person? | Their clearest sentence defining the problem |
|---|------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1 |                        |                          |                                   | Y / N                           |                                              |
| 2 |                        |                          |                                   | Y / N                           |                                              |
| 3 |                        |                          |                                   | Y / N                           |                                              |

## Step 4 — The validation verdict

Based on my interviews, the problem I identified in Assignment 1A is **validated / partially validated / not validated**, because...

**Evidence the problem exists:**

**Evidence it can be clearly defined** (state it in one sentence, in the customers' own words):

**Evidence multiple customers experience it** (how many of your interviewees raised it without prompting?):

**What surprised me:**

**Adjustment decision:** I will **keep / refine / replace** my problem statement because... (If the interviews reveal the problem isn't real, document what you learned and adjust — that IS the design-thinking process, and the exam FRQ rewards documenting iteration.)

**Trap check — one sentence each:**

Why is "Wouldn't you say it's annoying that there's no \_\_\_\_ nearby?" a broken interview question?

Why must you NOT show your product idea during a validation interview?

**Self-check:**

- ☐ 3+ interviews, at least one outside my friend group — EK 1.4.C.1
- ☐ Questions are open-ended and neutral — EK 1.4.A.2
- ☐ All **three validation bars** addressed with specific evidence — EK 1.4.C.1
- ☐ I made and justified an **adjustment decision** — not just "it's validated"

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## SECTION 3: TASK 4 — THE SOLUTION (Product Concept)

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*LO 1.4.C · EK 1.4.C.2 · EK 1.1.B.1–1.1.B.3 · Skill 2.A*

Now design a solution to the **validated** problem — through brainstorming, sketching, and prototyping (EK 1.4.C.2), not assumption. Keep it within school safety, health, and legal guidelines.

**Product name:**

**Type:** Good / Service / App / Hybrid

**One-sentence description:**

**Core features (maximum 3 — this is your MVP scope; everything else waits):** 1. 2. 3.

**Feature-to-evidence table** — every feature must trace to something an interviewee actually said:

| Core feature | The interview evidence behind it (which finding, which interviewee) |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
|              |                                                                     |
|              |                                                                     |

**Problem-solution fit statement:** "For \_\_\_ who \_\_\_ (validated problem, Section 2), my product is a \_\_\_ that \_\_\_. Unlike \_\_\_ (a 1A competitor), it \_\_\_ (your 1A competitive strategy — differentiation / cost leadership / niche)."

**Value creation & capture sketch:**

|                                        | Estimate |
|----------------------------------------|----------|
| Price per unit                         | \$       |
| Cost per unit                          | \$       |
| Value captured per unit (price – cost) | \$       |

(If you cannot yet charge more than it costs, say so honestly — Unit 3 is where the finance becomes rigorous. What matters here is that you have **thought in both directions**: value created for the customer, value captured by the business.)

**Resources:** what you already have (Section 1C strengths) vs. what you would need to acquire.

**Self-check:**

- ☐ Every core feature traces to **interview evidence**, not team preference — EK 1.4.C.2
- ☐ The fit statement connects to the **validated problem** and my **1A competitive strategy**
- ☐ The MVP scope is genuinely minimal (a sketch, description, or model is enough — EK 1.4.C.3)
- ☐ I developed this idea through brainstorming/sketching/prototyping — EK 1.4.C.2

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## SECTION 4: TASK 5 — HYPOTHESIS TEST + THE ENTREPRENEUR'S DECISION

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LO 1.4.C · EK 1.4.C.3 · LO 1.4.B · EK 1.4.B.1, 1.4.B.2 · Skill 2.B

Your product idea is an **assumption**. Now test it with an MVP.

### Step 1 — Write the hypothesis (specific and measurable)

"If \_\_\_ (target customer, Section 2) **are offered** \_\_\_ (MVP — simplest version, core features only), **then** at least \_\_\_ (number or %) **will** \_\_\_ (the behavior you will count: buy / pre-order / sign up / return for a second use), **because** \_\_\_ (reason drawn from your interview evidence)."

*Weak:* "If students like my product, they will buy it." *Strong:* "If 20 players on the basketball team are offered a pre-order form for a \$3 snack box at Friday's practice, then at least 8 will pre-order by Thursday, because 3 of 4 interviewed players said they currently skip the far vending machine."

## Step 2 — Build the MVP

The simplest version, with only core features — "a sketch, a description, or a model" (EK 1.4.C.3). Attach or describe it here:

## Step 3 — Run a BEHAVIOR test

A survey that only gathers opinions does **not** count. The test must observe what people **do** when the product is actually offered. Choose one or more:

- ☐ **Pre-order sign-up** — commitment at a stated price, before you produce
- ☐ **Small trial sale** — make a few units, count who buys at the real price
- ☐ **Observational pilot** — offer it, count actual use and repeat use

**Test method and sample:**

**Success criteria — written BEFORE the test:** I will consider the hypothesis **confirmed** if \_\_\_ and **rejected** if \_\_\_.

## Step 4 — Results and decision

**What happened (numbers, not adjectives):**

**Confirmed / partially confirmed / rejected:**

**How the test shaped a decision** (required documentation — the CED wants evidence that hypothesis testing changed something): I decided to \_\_\_ because \_\_\_.

## Step 5 — The entrepreneur's decision (risk and return)

Bringing a product to market "requires financial, physical, and human resources, which have costs, and there is no guarantee that a new product will generate enough revenue to cover the costs or earn profits" (EK 1.4.B.1).

**Estimated investment to start:** \$

**My two biggest risks** (name them — if you can name it, it's risk, not uncertainty): 1. 2.

**Potential return if it works** (what you get back, and more): revenue \_\_\_\_\_ – investment \_\_\_\_\_ = \$\_\_\_\_\_

**Where my venture sits on the risk–return table** (candy → restaurant → tech startup): \_\_\_\_\_ risk × \_\_\_\_\_ potential return, because...

**Why I accept the risk** (EK 1.4.B.2 — check all that apply and explain):

- ☐ potential future profits
- ☐ the satisfaction of solving a problem
- ☐ the ability to pursue a passion

**The verdict: proceed as planned / adjust the product / change the target customer / pivot**, because...

*(Class anchors: Copa Di Vino — the market judged, not the "experts"; 密室逃脱 — hot demand, zero repeat buyers, still collapsed. Your test result is a point-in-time viability signal, not a promise.)*

*Stretch (Personal Finance link — Earning Income 12-11):* If you actually ran this business, what would your **income as an owner** depend on? (Hint: profit, not wages — revenue minus all costs, and only if there's a surplus.)

**Self-check:**

- ☐ Hypothesis is specific and measurable, with the success threshold set **before** the test — Skill 2.B
- ☐ The test measured **behavior** (pre-orders, purchases, use), not opinions — EK 1.4.C.3
- ☐ I documented **how the test shaped a decision** — required for the canvas
- ☐ I **named** my risks (risk ≠ uncertainty) and stated why I accept them — EK 1.4.B.1, 1.4.B.2

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## SECTION 5: TASK 6 — THE ORGANIZATION: Values, Competencies, Vision, Mission, Type

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LO 1.5.A · EK 1.5.A.1–1.5.A.5 · LO 1.5.B · EK 1.5.B.1–1.5.B.3 · LO 1.5.C · EK 1.5.C.1–1.5.C.3 · Skill 4.B

Your product now has evidence behind it. Now define what the business **is** — the section a customer or investor reads before the first transaction (EK 1.5.B.3).

## 5A. The cooler lid — core values and core competencies

**Core values (2–3) — what the business BELIEVES** (EK 1.5.A.1 — e.g., reliability, transparency, fairness; his cooler lid said: *show up on time, listen to the families, keep prices fair*): 1. 2. 3.

**Core competencies (2–3) — what the business IS GOOD AT** (EK 1.5.A.3 — e.g., his pre-order system, the 60-second halftime handoff): 1. 2. 3.

**The pairing discipline:** for each item, ask — does the evidence say we **believe** it (value) or we are **good at** it (competency)? Swap any misfiled item now.

**Trace to 1A:** which competency feeds the competitive advantage you claimed in Assignment 1A? (Competencies feed competitive advantage — trace an advantage backward and you find a capability somebody built.)

## 5B. The decoration check (run on EACH stated value)

A value the business abandons the first time money appears was a **decoration**. Seesaw wrote "craft" on the wall and dropped it in the first price war; Patagonia's values survived every test and cost it real revenue each time.

| Value<br>(from<br>5A) | 1. Falsifiable?<br>Point to one<br>concrete<br>decision it<br>governs | 2. Cost<br>trace? Name<br>a deal where<br>keeping it<br>would cost<br>you money | 3. Incentives<br>aligned? Would any<br>teammate/bonus<br>logic reward the<br>opposite? | 4. Would<br>anyone<br>oppose it? (If<br>no one would,<br>it constrains<br>nothing) |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                       |                                                                       |                                                                                 |                                                                                        |                                                                                    |

**The Seesaw question:** if a deep-pocketed partner offered to double your margin but required breaking value #1, what would you do? Write the answer your value actually dictates:

(If you cannot answer, the value is a decoration — rewrite it until it would cost you something.)

## 5C. Vision and mission

|              | Vision statement                                                                               | Mission statement                                                                                    |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Describes    | the <b>future</b> worth wanting — aspirations + core values, <b>no operations</b> (EK 1.5.B.1) | <b>what the business does and how</b> it will achieve its long-term goals (EK 1.5.B.2)               |
| In one word  | Aspiration                                                                                     | Operation                                                                                            |
| Class anchor | "Game days where no family scrambles."                                                         | "Deliver pre-ordered snack boxes to every team by halftime, reliably, at prices families can trust." |

**My vision statement:**

**My mission statement:**

**Run the tests (classify by content, not by label):**

- ☐ My vision contains **no operations** (no "we deliver / provide / sell...") — if it does, it's a mission
- ☐ My mission names the **what** and the **how** — EK 1.5.B.2
- ☐ My mission is consistent with the **values** from 5A

**The external job (EK 1.5.B.3)** — the statements earn trust **before the first transaction**:

What would a **customer** learn from my mission without buying anything? (The wholesale parent learned *the fruit stays*.)

What would a **partner or investor** learn from my vision without sitting in a single meeting?

**The cooler-lid decision:** name one decision a teammate could make correctly by reading your mission alone, when nobody's watching:

**The two-offer test:** imagine the highest-margin expansion a deep-pocketed partner could fund for your business. What does your mission answer — **does the fruit stay or go?**

## 5D. Organization type (the decision tree)

1. **Can owners keep the profit at all?** If **no** — every surplus feeds the mission → **nonprofit** (surplus must be reinvested **by law**; revenue may include grants and donations — EK 1.5.C.3)
2. If **yes** — is a **social objective built into** the products, operations, or financial model? If **yes** → **social enterprise** (owners keep profit — EK 1.5.C.2). If **no** → **business** (EK 1.5.C.1)

**My organization type:** business / social enterprise / nonprofit

**Walk the tree — my answer at each step:**

**If social enterprise — the channel that carries the objective:** products / operations / financial model

**Where the surplus goes** (whom the gains ultimately serve — one sentence):

**How my business will improve profit** (EK 1.5.C.1 — name the two levers): increase revenues by \_\_\_ and/or decrease costs by \_\_\_

*Stretch (Personal Finance link — Earning Income 12-3):* The same tool points at **you**: individuals consider their own core values and core competencies when choosing educational, career, and job opportunities (EK 1.5.A.5). What do your answers in 5A say about the paths that fit — and don't fit — **you**?

**Self-check:**

- ☐ Values = believes; competencies = good at — nothing misfiled (the exam's favorite swap)
- ☐ Each value survives the decoration check — or was rewritten until it would cost something
- ☐ Vision has no operations; mission has what + how — classified **by content** — EK 1.5.B.1, 1.5.B.2
- ☐ The statements do the external job — a customer or partner learns something before the first sale — EK 1.5.B.3
- ☐ Organization type justified by the decision tree, with the **destination of the surplus** named — EK 1.5.C.1–1.5.C.3

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## SECTION 6: EXAM DRILL — The Tells

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Classify by content, not by label. These rehearse the classification questions the exam asks — on scenarios and on your own project.

| # | Item                                                                                     | Classification                           | One-sentence reason (name the tell) |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1 | Alibaba's official <b>mission</b> : "Make it easy to do business anywhere"               | vision / mission                         |                                     |
| 2 | Bright Thread's "fastest turnaround of any tailor, built on Rosa's scheduling system"    | value / competency                       |                                     |
| 3 | "A chain with lower prices might open across the street next year"                       | risk / uncertainty                       |                                     |
| 4 | A café staffed entirely by formerly incarcerated baristas; owners keep the profit        | business / social enterprise / nonprofit |                                     |
| 5 | A foundation-funded literacy café where every surplus is reinvested and no owner is paid | business / social enterprise / nonprofit |                                     |

**#1 trap:** it reads aspirational — but does it describe **what the company does** (enable commerce) or a future with no operations? Defend your call.

### Self-check:

- ☐ I classified every item by its **content/tell**, not its label
- ☐ I can distinguish **believes** from **good at** on sight
- ☐ I can distinguish a **nameable danger** (risk) from the unnameable (uncertainty)
- ☐ For #4 vs. #5, I can name the **destination of the money** that settles the classification

## Grading Rubric

| Section                                         | Excellent (A)                                                                                                                                           | Good (B)                                                         | Developing (C)                                               | Needs Work (D/F)            |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>1 — Idea audit (1.4)</b>                     | Source(s) named with specific evidence; fake-gap check engages how the need is met today; enabler vs. source distinguished; strengths honestly assessed | Source named with some evidence; most checks run                 | Source asserted without evidence; checks skipped             | Not addressed               |
| <b>2 — Validation interviews — Task 3 (1.4)</b> | 3+ interviews; questions genuinely open-ended and neutral; all 3 validation bars evidenced with quotes/numbers; adjustment decision justified           | 3 interviews; bars mostly evidenced; decision stated             | Fewer than 3 interviews, or leading questions; weak evidence | No interviews or no verdict |
| <b>3 — Product concept — Task 4 (1.4)</b>       | Every feature traces to interview evidence; fit statement integrates the validated problem + 1A strategy; MVP genuinely minimal; value                  | Product connected to problem; some evidence; MVP loosely minimal | Product loosely connected; features from team preference     | No real product concept     |

| Section                                        | Excellent (A)                                                                                                                                                                   | Good (B)                                                       | Developing (C)                                         | Needs Work (D/F) |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
|                                                | sketch thinks both directions                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                |                                                        |                  |
| <b>4 — Hypothesis test — Task 5 (1.4)</b>      | Measurable hypothesis; success criteria set before the test; behavior-based results in numbers; decision documented; risk–return judgment names risks and motivation (EK 1.4.B) | Test run with some numbers; decision stated; risk acknowledged | Opinion-based test or no criteria; vague decision      | No test          |
| <b>5A–5B — Values &amp; competencies (1.5)</b> | Believes/good-at discipline held; each value passes the decoration check or was rewritten; competency traced to the 1A advantage                                                | Mostly distinct; most checks run                               | Values/competencies confused; decoration check skipped | Not addressed    |
| <b>5C–5D — Vision, mission, type (1.5)</b>     | Vision operation-free; mission has what + how; statements do the external job (two-offer/cooler-lid tests answered);                                                            | Statements mostly correct; type justified                      | Vision/mission interchangeable; type asserted          | Not addressed    |

| Section               | Excellent (A)                                                        | Good (B)     | Developing (C) | Needs Work (D/F) |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------|------------------|
|                       | type walked through the decision tree with surplus destination named |              |                |                  |
| <b>6 — Exam drill</b> | All correct with tell-based reasoning                                | Most correct | Several errors | Mostly incorrect |

## Important Notes

1. **Same business idea** as Assignments 1A and 1.3 — same customer, same market, same competitors. If your interviews reveal the problem isn't real, **document and adjust** — iteration is the design-thinking process, and the exam rewards the documentation, not a "clean" story.
2. **Hypothesis testing is not optional.** Customer and Product are asterisked canvas elements — the CED **requires** evidence of testing. Sections 2 and 4 are that evidence. "We tested it and people liked it" is the weak version; "the number said X, so we changed Y" is the strong version.
3. **Teams:** same team as 1A; one submission; all members contribute. Interviews may be split among members — but every member must be able to explain all findings, because the exam-day FRQ is written **individually**, about the project you all know.
4. **Evidence beats assertion, still.** "People would definitely buy this" is weak; "3 of 4 interviewees said they skip the far vending machine, so I set my success threshold at 8 of 20 pre-orders" is strong.
5. **AP Exam connection:** the Business Canvas Project Exam-Day Validation FRQ (15% of your score) asks about **your own project** — your validated problem, how you tested a hypothesis and what changed as a result, and a challenge to your business's viability. Sections 2, 4, and 5 are ready-made FRQ material: your interview evidence, your test numbers, your risk–return judgment, and your two-offer answer.

6. **What's next:** Topics 1.6 (ethics) and 1.7 (roles) are AP content but not canvas tasks. Then Topic 1.8 brings **Assignment 1C** (production process + supply chain plan) — where the core competencies you listed in 5A start doing real work — and the **Unit 1 Final Canvas** asks you to commit to your idea and integrate everything.